

The Discording Tales



A next-gen immersive simulation Action RPG where exploration, simulation and player freedom create unforgettable experiences.

Created by

Hugues de Pingon · Théotime Millois · Quentin Huengi · Zeineb Geissbühler ·
Nolan Zannato · Delphine Martres · Dylan Harbi · Mathias Rufer · Patrice Le

Executive Summary

The Discording Tales is more than a game; it is the first expression of an original entertainment IP built for long-term growth.

Over the past five years, our team has developed a rich fantasy universe with its own history, civilizations, cultures and mysteries. Originally conceived as a tabletop role-playing game, it has naturally evolved into ***The Discording Tales***, a next-generation immersive Action RPG and the foundation of a much broader intellectual property.

The project is driven by a multidisciplinary team combining professional experience in game design, technology, art and business strategy. By bringing together creative vision with technical and commercial expertise, we are building not only a compelling game, but a sustainable franchise designed to evolve through sequels, meaningful expansions and new forms of storytelling.

The Discording Tales is only the first chapter of a much larger story.

Project at a glance	
Genre	First-person immersive sim Action RPG.
Estimated Playtime	2–3 hours for the demo, 20+ hours for the full game.
Target Audience	Core PC and console players.
Target Players	Mid-core and casual players who enjoy immersive worlds such as The Elder Scrolls III: Morrowind, Gloomwood, and immersive RPGs centred on exploration, player agency, and discovery.
Platforms	PC at launch, with console releases considered in the future. Keyboard & mouse and full controller support.
Distribution	Steam (initial release).
Age Rating	PEGI 13–16 (target, violence and mature themes).
Pricing	Premium title, with Early Access from approximately \$30, followed by a full commercial release.
Business Model	Kickstarter → Early Access → Full Release → Modding Support → Major Expansions

Our Ambition

To build one of the world's most distinctive immersive fantasy IPs.

We believe the next generation of RPGs will be defined by systemic gameplay rather than scripted content. *The Discording Tales* combines immersive simulation, player freedom and a rich original universe to create experiences that players genuinely own.

Our ambition goes beyond a single game; we are laying the foundation for a long-term entertainment franchise. At its heart lies an original fantasy universe designed to expand through multiple games, stories, and complementary creative media, while fostering a passionate community that will help shape its future.

The Discording Tales is not our destination ; it is only our beginning.





The Opportunity

Modern RPGs increasingly guide players through carefully scripted experiences, leaving little room for genuine experimentation, discovery and player-driven storytelling.

- **Predictable experiences → Players feel constrained.**

As production costs rise, many studios prioritize proven formulas and familiar mechanics, resulting in increasingly guided experiences rather than truly emergent worlds.

- **Limited player agency → Players crave meaningful choice.**

Despite increasingly larger and more detailed worlds, many games still funnel players toward predetermined solutions. Players increasingly value experiences where their choices, experimentation, and creativity genuinely shape the world around them.

- **Fewer original universes → New IP is increasingly scarce.**

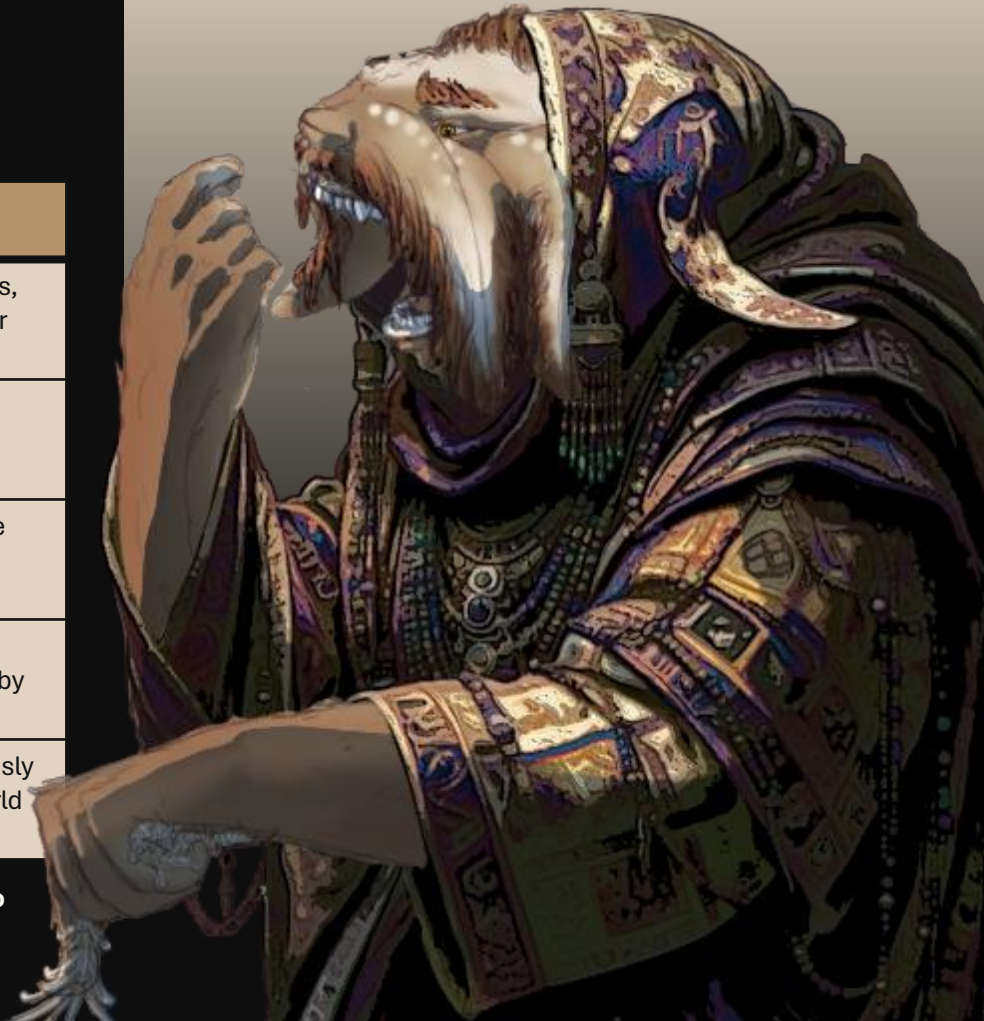
The industry continues to expand, yet fewer new intellectual properties establish truly distinctive worlds capable of becoming enduring franchises. Players increasingly seek universes with a strong identity and lasting depth.

Our Solution

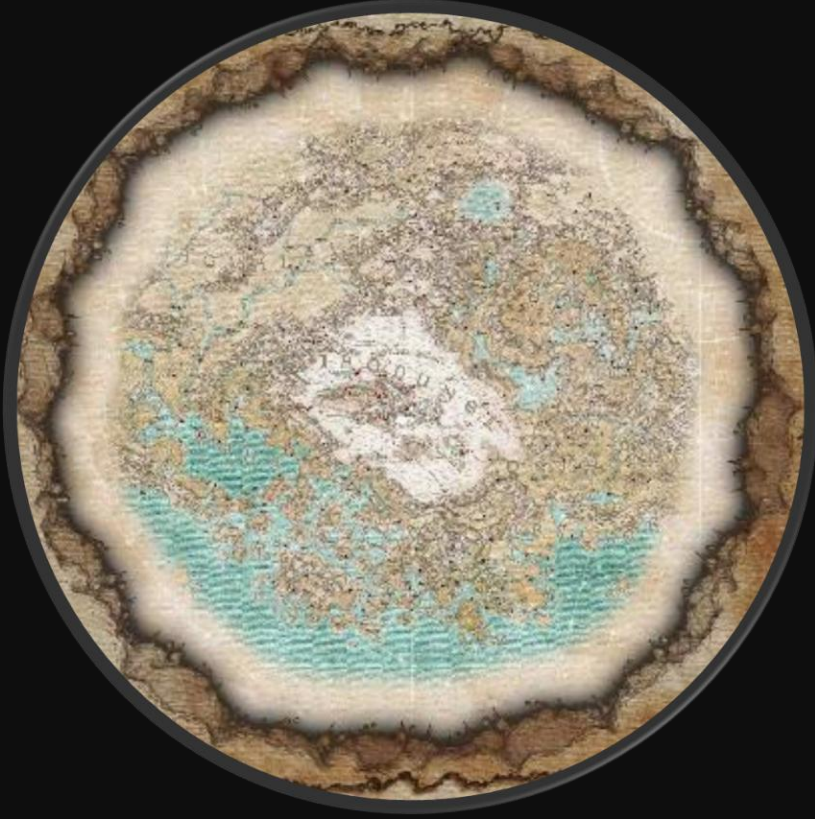
Building worlds that players truly make their own and with high replayability.

Promise	How we deliver it
Freedom	Systemic gameplay creates multiple valid approaches, allowing players to solve challenges according to their own playstyle.
Discovery	A handcrafted universe rich in mystery, culture and hidden knowledge, where understanding the world continually unlocks new opportunities.
Emergence	Physics, and interconnected systems naturally create unexpected situations and memorable gameplay moments.
Ownership	Persistent systems and meaningful player choices ensure every playthrough tells a unique story shaped by the player.
Replayability	New tools, knowledge and abilities transform previously explored areas, encouraging players to revisit the world from a new perspective.

The result is a next-generation immersive simulation Action RPG where no two stories are ever the same.



A Universe Built to Last



- **A Vertical Civilization**

Beneath the frozen remains of the ancient Lake Iaôdunaï lies a vast interconnected world of caverns, forgotten cities, ancient ruins, and thriving civilizations. Every layer tells a different story, offering its own cultures, ecosystems, and dangers.

- **Ancient Technology & Mystery**

Long-forgotten relics infused with Rilie, an ancient techno-magical force, have triggered a race for knowledge and power. Beneath every discovery lies another mystery waiting to reshape the player's understanding of the world.

- **A Living Political Ecosystem**

Factions, cultures, and civilizations pursue their own ambitions through alliances, commerce, conflict, and betrayal. The world continues to evolve whether the player intervenes or not.

- **A Personal Journey with Global Consequences**

Awakening from an experimental stasis with no memory of your past, your search for identity gradually reveals a far greater conflict: the return of Dærg hul and the future of an entire civilization.

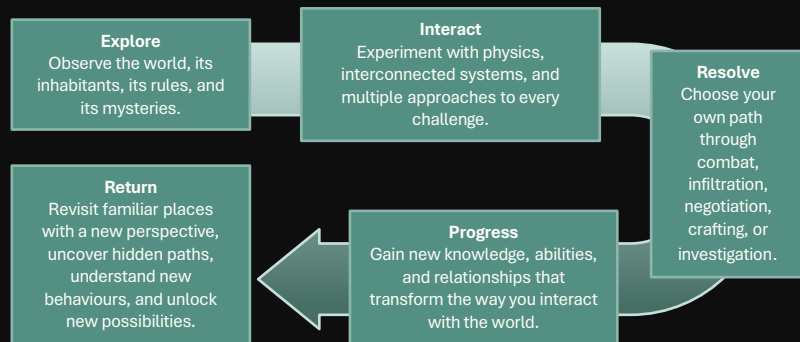
Every descent uncovers another layer of history, mystery, and possibility.



The Player Experience

A world where almost everything is visible, but almost nothing can be mastered without understanding it.

Core Gameplay Loop



What the player experiences :

- Every discovery reveals a new way of understanding the world.
- Obstacles become opportunities as knowledge grows.
- Emergent situations arise naturally.
- The greatest reward is the moment of realization.

Player Agency in Action

Situation

The player discovers a rope leading upward, a side tunnel, and a locked gate guarded by a patrol.

Rather than prescribing a single solution, the world encourages experimentation.

Players may:

- Sneak through hidden passages.
- Manipulate light and the environment.
- Exploit creature behaviours.
- Fight or negotiate.
- Use previously acquired knowledge to unlock new opportunities.

Every choice creates different consequences.

The player's decisions influence progression, encounters, and future opportunities.

A World Worth Revisiting

Returning later with new knowledge, tools, or relationships reveals hidden shortcuts, new interactions, and entirely different ways to experience familiar places.

Progress is not only about going further—it is about seeing the world differently.





What Makes The Discording Tales Unique?

A Living Original Universe.

More than five years of worldbuilding have shaped an original fantasy setting with rich civilizations, interconnected cultures and evolving factions, laying the foundation for a lasting entertainment franchise.

A Truly Systemic World.

Most RPGs contain systems. Our world is built **around systems**. Physics, environment, factions, creatures and player actions constantly interact to create unexpected situations.

Meaningful Player Freedom.

Challenges rarely have a single solution.

Players choose how to explore, overcome obstacles and shape their own journey according to their playstyle.

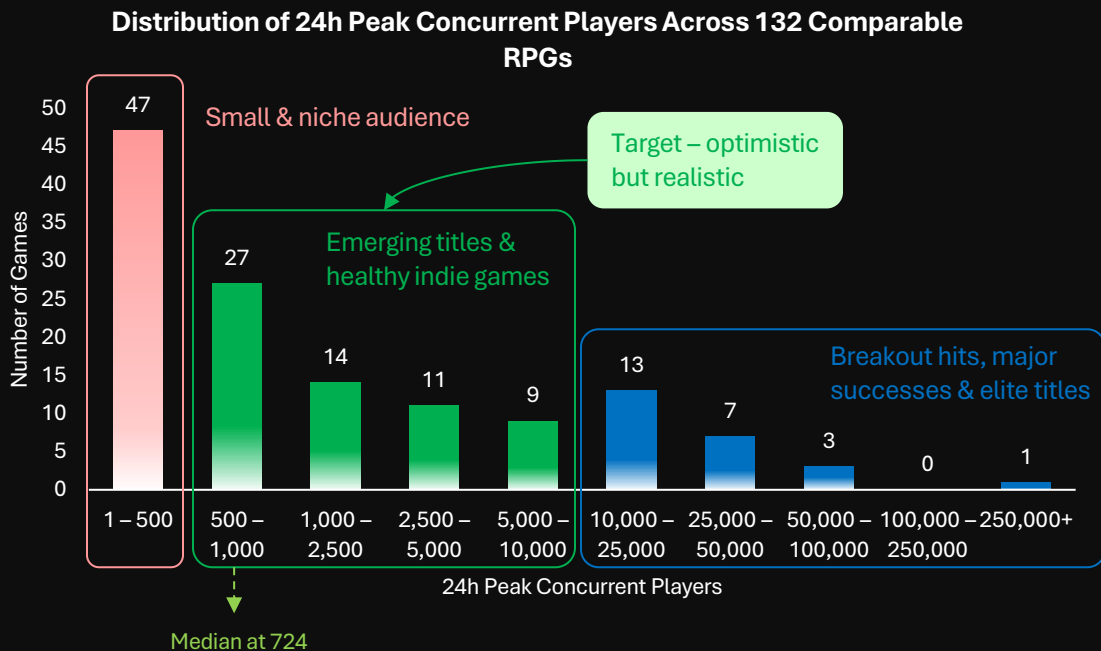
Discovery Through Understanding.

Progress comes from learning how the world works—not simply becoming stronger.

Knowledge itself becomes one of the player's most valuable tools.

Market Opportunity

Our analysis of Steam identified 132 games directly comparable to *The Discording Tales*. These titles collectively reached more than 1.5 million peak concurrent players over a 24-hour period, demonstrating a large and highly engaged audience on PC alone. This analysis excludes console platforms such as PlayStation and Xbox, suggesting the total addressable audience for this genre is significantly larger.



Why We Are Positioned to Win

1 Growing Premium RPG Market

Premium RPGs continue to attract millions of highly engaged players seeking deep, high-quality experiences.

2 Underserved Segment

Despite strong demand, relatively few studios develop systemic immersive RPGs, leaving room for differentiated experiences.

3 Players Reward Original IP

Recent successes demonstrate that players actively embrace new worlds with distinctive identities and memorable experiences.

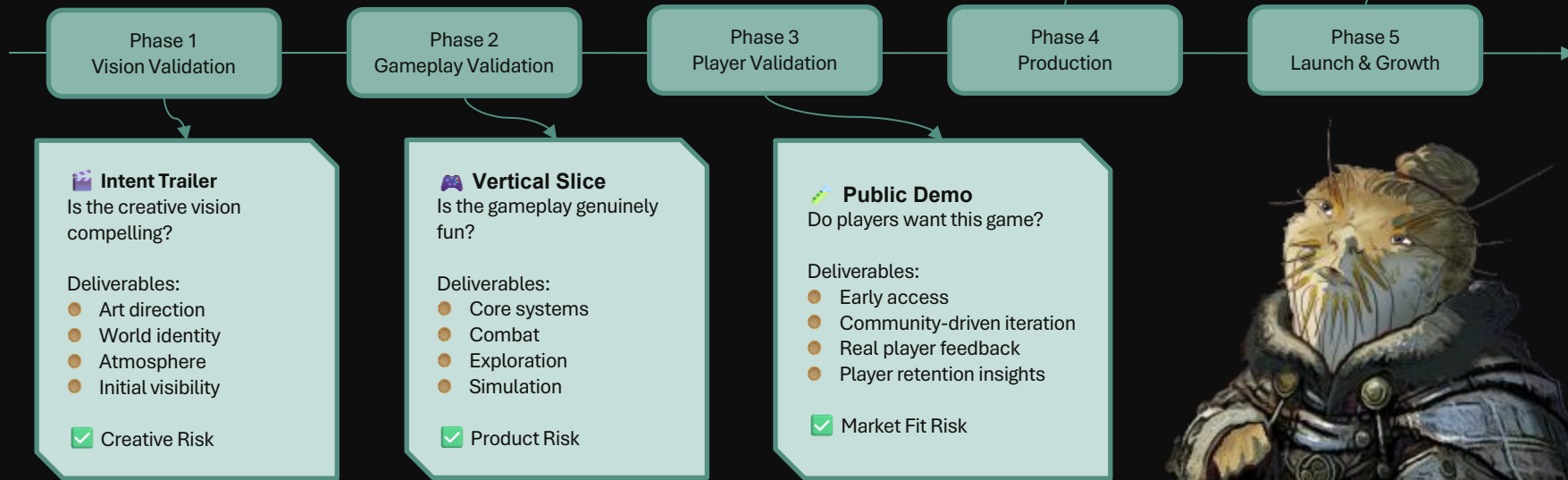
4 Positioned for Long-Term Value

Designed as an original IP from day one, *The Discording Tales* is built to grow through sequels, expansions, and cross-media storytelling.

Development Strategy

Our development strategy is built around a stage-gated validation framework. Each milestone is designed to answer a critical question and reduce a specific project risk before moving to the next phase.

Alongside development, we will continuously monitor community interest and player feedback through Steam, wishlists, social media, crowdfunding campaigns, public playtests, and other engagement channels to ensure the project evolves in line with player expectations and market demand.



Progress So Far

From vision to execution: laying the foundations for a long-term franchise.

A Mature Creative Vision

- More than **five years** of worldbuilding and universe development.
- Original lore, civilizations, factions, and narrative established.
- Strong artistic direction and long-term franchise vision.

Gameplay Foundations Defined

- Core gameplay loop fully designed.
- Systemic gameplay philosophy established.
- Key simulation mechanics identified.
- Technical architecture validated.

Team Assembled

- Multidisciplinary team brought together.
- Creative, technical, artistic, audio, and business expertise.
- Shared long-term vision and collaboration framework in place.

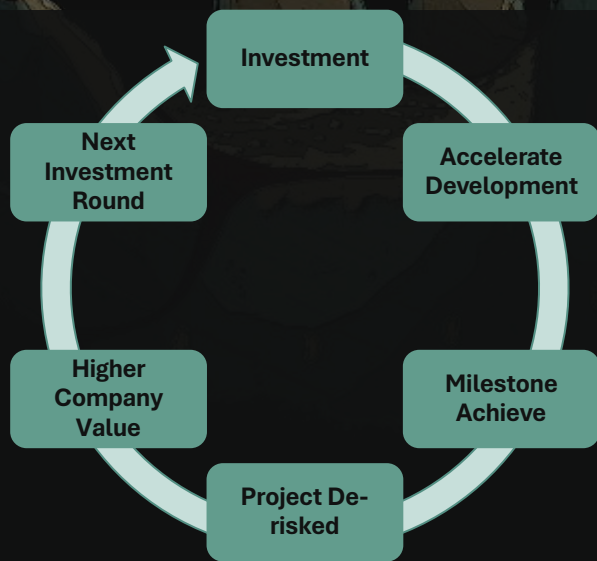
Production Ready

- Comprehensive Game Design Document completed.
- Project governance and IP framework established.
- Development roadmap and milestone plan defined.
- Initial funding and partnership discussions underway.

Investment Strategy

Capital deployed to accelerate development, unlock value, and systematically reduce project risk.

Rather than funding the entire journey upfront, we seek strategic investment that accelerates each development milestone. Every milestone increases the value of the project by validating key assumptions, reducing uncertainty, and preparing the next stage of growth.



Investment Area	Primary Objective
 Team Allocation	Increase the team's dedicated time allocation to accelerate development.
 Production	Accelerate game development.
 Community	Build and validate player demand.
 Operations	Protect and structure the business.
 Growth	Secure partnerships and future funding.

Every investment milestone strengthens confidence in the project while creating measurable value for future partners and investors.

Long-Term IP Strategy

Our greatest asset is not the game, but it is the universe behind it.

Over the past five years, we have built an original universe designed to support countless stories, civilizations, and experiences. Initially conceived as a tabletop role-playing game, this universe has naturally evolved into ***The Discording Tales***, our first video game and the initial expression of a much broader intellectual property. Video games are our starting point because they are where our team's expertise is strongest.

Our ambition extends far beyond a single title. We aim to continuously expand this universe through sequels, meaningful expansions, and new forms of storytelling that enrich the world, grow the community, and establish a lasting entertainment franchise.

We are not building a single game; we are laying the foundation for a lasting entertainment franchise.

Meet the Team



Creator of *The Discording Tales* Universe & Creative Director

- Over **five years** dedicated to creating the universe of *The Discording Tales*.
- **Lead Game Designer** on **The Wayward Realms**, developed by the original creators of **The Elder Scrolls** series.
- Responsible for the project's **creative vision, game design, narrative, and overall creative direction**.

Creative Portfolio: [Hugues de Pignon](#) | [Lead Game Designer, Philosopher & System Designer](#)



Game Designer & Gameplay Programmer

Hugues



Level Designer & Hard Surface 3D Artist

Dylan



Organic 3D Artist & Technical Artist

Zeineb, Théotime, Nolan



Simulation & Physics Engineer

Delphine



Sound Design & Music Composition

Quentin, Mathias



Strategy, Product & Business Development

Patrice

The Discording Tales is being developed by a multidisciplinary team of independent creators, bringing together emerging talent from Switzerland's video game ecosystem. Their complementary expertise spans every core discipline required to bring an ambitious RPG to life—from creative direction and engineering to art, audio, and business strategy.

United by a shared ambition: to build an original immersive RPG where artistic vision, systemic design, and meaningful player freedom come together to create unforgettable experiences.

Based in Switzerland



thediscordingtales@gmail.com

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Team Profiles



Hugues de Pingon – Creative Director & Lead Game Designer

Hugues is the Lead Game Designer on The Wayward Realms, developed by the co-creators of The Elder Scrolls series. Creator of The Discording Tales universe, which he inspired the project. He leads the creative direction, game design, gameplay systems, narrative, and overall coherence of the project's transmedia universe.



Patrice Le – Strategy, Product & Business Development

Patrice is Vice President, **EMEA Commercial & Product Management** at **MSCI**, with over seven years of experience across MSCI and Bloomberg. He brings expertise in product strategy, commercial development, fundraising preparation, and go-to-market execution, supporting the project's positioning, growth strategy, and long-term development.

Théotime Millois – Character & Creature Artist

Théotime holds a Bachelor's degree in Game Art & Animation and specialises in character and creature sculpting. With extensive experience in 3D printing and miniature painting, he brings strong expertise in anatomy, form, and visual design. He is responsible for the creation of the game's characters, creatures, and core 3D assets.

Zeineb Geissbühler – Character Artist

Zeineb is a 3D artist with a background in Visual Arts and an MBA in E-Business & Digital Strategy. Specialising in digital sculpting and character creation, she designs and sculpts the game's characters, giving each a distinctive visual identity while reflecting the diversity of the world's cultures.

Nolan Zannato – Technical Artist

Nolan holds both a Swiss Federal Diploma in Information Technology and a Bachelor's degree in Game Art & Animation. Combining programming and technical art, he develops the production tools, technical workflows, and engine solutions that enable the artistic vision of The Discording Tales.

Delphine Martres – Simulation & Physics Programmer

Delphine is a PhD candidate in Physics at the University of Oslo, following a Master's degree from EPFL specialising in Quantum Computing. She develops the game's physical simulation systems, applying her expertise in modelling and programming to support level design and emergent gameplay.

Dylan Harbi – Level Designer & Environment Artist

Dylan is a professional 3D designer with an initial background in watchmaking, bringing exceptional precision and attention to detail. He contributes to level design while creating environments and architectural assets that shape the game's world.

Quentin Huengi – Sound Designer

Quentin is an independent sound designer and founder of Rituel Audio Design. Specialising in sound design, synthesis, and audio implementation, he collaborates with multiple game studios and is responsible for the audio identity and sound design of The Discording Tales.

Mathias Rufer – Composer

Mathias studies percussion at the Lucerne University of Applied Sciences and Arts. Inspired by composers such as John Williams, Howard Shore, Nobuo Uematsu, and Yoko Shimomura, he composes the original soundtrack, strengthening the game's atmosphere and identity.